

RENOWN — ESCALATION CAMPAIGN

A fast, battle-driven mode for 2+ players. Ten+ turns.

DICE PRINCIPLE

A successful roll is written as **X+**: roll that number or higher on a **d6**. Apply modifiers to the **roll**: **+1** per bonus, **−1** per penalty; each negative modifier requires your roll to be one higher to succeed, each positive modifier one lower. **If a 7 or more is ever needed to succeed a roll, it automatically fails; if a 1 or less is ever needed, it automatically passes.** **Note:** if a roll automatically passes or fails but a natural result could still trigger an effect, you still roll the die to see whether that effect triggers.

A **natural** roll is the die before modifiers. A **natural 6** triggers **Cleave, Deadly, Destroy Shield and Riposte** (and a natural-6 Save fails against Poison).

The rolls: **Roll-off** — higher **Seizes the Initiative**; **to Strike** — roll $\geq$ to-Strike number; **Parry** — roll $\geq$ 5 (Improved 4+), natural 6 = Riposte; **to Save** — roll $-\text{AP} + \text{shield bonus} \geq \text{armor value}$; **Recover** — roll $\geq$ X; **Panic** — roll $\geq$ Morale value; **Break** — roll $\geq$ Morale value.

SETUP

Each player starts with an **army composition** of **25 Levy retainues, Farm Tools, Cloth armor, no shield**. All four Domains (**Industry, Prowess, Piety, Cunning**) start **Untested** (no effect). No Pursuits, 0 Victory Points (VP). Every Battle is fought at an army size of **25**; what carries over between Battles is your **Standings, Pursuits, unlocks, and VP**.

TURN SEQUENCE

1 — BATTLE. Pair off and fight one Battle (rotate pairings each turn).

Result	VP
Decisive Win: Reduce the enemy army to zero or cause a Rout.	+3
Minor Victory: The enemy army Fell Back.	+2
Lose, but end it via a successful Fall Back with 1+ retinue remaining.	+1
Lose any other way (wiped out, Routed, failed Fall Back).	0

2 — ADVANCEMENT (all players simultaneously):

- **Unlock one Domain Standing:** advance any one Domain one step — Untested → Rising → Established → Sovereign, if the prior standing is already unlocked.
- **Perform one Build Action:** construct one Pursuit whose build requirements you satisfy.
- **You may change your army to any other composition you have unlocked.** You must announce it before the end of the turn. If it's an issue, both players play their army's composition face down and reveal simultaneously.

BATTLE WALKTHROUGH

Begin the Battle — roll off for the Initiative. Each player rolls one d6 — **+1 if you won your last Battle** — re-rolling ties. The higher roller **Seizes the Initiative**: they are the **Attacker** for this Battle and gain **+1 Initiative in the first Skirmish**; their opponent is the **Defender**.

Fought as a series of **Skirmishes** — repeat these steps each Skirmish until the Battle ends; rule detail is in the Glossary.

- 1. Form the Field.** Each player places the maximum retainues available into the field, up to **10** retainues in the front line — one attack each — and up to 5 in reserve to replace losses before striking back.
- 2. Choose Tactics.** Both players secretly pick one **Tactic**, then reveal simultaneously.
- 3. Declare equipment.** The **Attacker** names their equipment first; the **Defender** then names theirs.
- 4. Initiative.** Initiative runs from **−2 to +2**. The higher Initiative Strikes first this Skirmish. At **−2 or lower you Blunder** — your **Strike** value cannot be improved beyond 6+.
- 5. Roll to Strike.** Roll a d6 for each front-line retinue. To calculate the to-Strike result needed: the Retinue's to-Strike, plus positive modifiers, minus 1 per Fatigue token, to a maximum of 6+, and then any other remaining negative modifiers.
- 6. Strike and defend.** Resolve the first player's **Strikes** — **Parry** (immediately resolve **Ripostes**), then **Save**, then **Recover**; the rest are casualties. Casualties leave the field immediately, lowering its **Field** count.
- 7. Panic check.** If any army takes **5 or more casualties** this Skirmish from combat at any time, it takes a **Panic check** immediately: roll a d6 per retinue in the field, **up to 5 dice**. If the result is ever **modified to require 7 or more, that army Routs instead**. You Panic at most once per Skirmish.
- 8. Strike back.** The other player Strikes the same way, if able.
- 9. Lose Endurance.** Each army that participated loses 1 Endurance. A player's army at 0 Endurance is **Fatigued**.
- 10. Break check.** Each **Fatigued** player's field takes a **break check** — before it gains a token: roll a d6 per retinue in the field, **up to 5 dice**, roll against **its modified Morale value** — modified negatively by 1 per Fatigue token and by other positive modifiers. Failures are casualties; a break check never triggers a Panic check. A Morale value ever **modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army**.
- 11. Fatigue token.** Then each Fatigued side gains a **Fatigue token** — each is **−1 to its Strike, Morale, Parry and Recover rolls**, all capped at 6+ except Morale (uncapped), and they stack.
- 12. End the Skirmish.** The Battle ends if a player's army size is reduced to 0, Routs, or successfully **Falls Back**. Otherwise start the next Skirmish at step 1. You cannot Fall Back during the first and second Skirmish of any Battle.

ARMORY REFERENCE

RETINUES (the physical capability of your Troops)

Retinue	Strike	Endur	Morale	Notes	Unlock
Levy	4+	3	5	—	—
Man-at-Arms	3+	3	4	—	Coliseum
Sergeant	2+	3	4	—	War College
Knight Templar	3+	3	4	Unbreakable	Preceptory

WEAPON TIERS

Five tiers, worst to best: **Crude** • **Cast** • **Wrought** • **Forged** • **Crafted**. Each tier is unlocked by an Industry Pursuit (see that Pursuit's effect under Pursuits). A weapon's tier is shown in its Tier column.

MELEE WEAPONS (Unwieldy = cannot gain Initiative from Tactics; vice versa for Steady)

Weapon	AP	Init	Tags	Note	Tier
Farm Tools	0	0	—	—	Crude
Cudgel	−1	−1	2H, Unwieldy	—	Crude
Pitchfork	0	+1	2H, Unwieldy	—	Crude
Daggers	0	+1	Nimble, 2H, Deadly	—	Cast
Short Sword	−1	0	Steady	—	Cast
Spears	−1	+1	Unwieldy	—	Cast
Arming Sword	−1	0	Steady, Deadly	—	Wrought
Pike	−2	+1	Unwieldy, Deadly, 2H	—	Wrought
Flail	−2	−1	Cleave	—	Wrought
Halberd	−3	0	2H	—	Wrought
Battle Axe	−2	−1	Unstoppable, 2H, Cleave	—	Wrought
Cavalry Spear	−2	0	Unwieldy, Steady	Needs Stable; no Tower Shield or Crossbow dual	Wrought
Bastard Sword	−3	0	Steady, Deadly	—	Forged
2HBastard	−3	0	Cleave, 2H, Unwieldy	—	Forged
Lance	−4	+1	Steady, Unwieldy, Deadly, Unstoppable	Needs Stable; no Tower Shield or Crossbow dual	Forged
Morningstar	−3	−1	Unwieldy, Destroy Shield, Cleave	—	Forged
War Hammer	−8	−1	Unwieldy, Destroy Shield, Unstoppable, 2H, Deadly	—	Forged
Poleaxe	−4	0	Steady, 2H, Unstoppable, Deadly, Cleave	—	Crafted

RANGED (all have Deflect; Fletchery to equip, Tiltyard to dual-equip. Deflect: −1 to Parry saves from Deflect weapons; cannot be Riposted)

Weapon	AP	Init	Tags	Note	Tier
Hunting Bow	−1	+2	2H, Deadly	—	Crude
Longbow	−2	+2	Deadly, 2H	—	Cast
Javelin	−3	+1	Deadly, Steady, Unstoppable, One Shot	—	Wrought
Crossbow	−4	0	Deadly, Unwieldy, Unstoppable	Tower Shield only (no other shield permitted)	Forged
Pilum	−5	+1	Steady, Destroy Shield, Unstoppable, One Shot, Deadly	—	Crafted

SHIELDS (require Joinery + the matching metal-tier building)

Shield	Save	Init	Tags	Tier
Wooden	+1	−1	Unwieldy	Crude
Kite	+1	0	Steady	Cast
Scutum	+1	−1	Unwieldy, -1 to Strike	Wrought
Tower	+2	−1	-1 to Strike, Unwieldy	Forged
Heater	+1	0	-1 to Strike, Immune Destroy Shield	Crafted

ARMOR (Save target; heavier Armor grants Unwieldy — nothing happens if Unwieldy stacks)

Armor	Save	Tags	Unlocked by	Tier
Cloth	6+	—	—	Crude
Leather	5+	—	Tannery	Cast
Chainmail	4+	—	Armory	Wrought
Full Plate	3+	—	Gilded Foundry	Forged
Gothic Plate	2+	—	Advanced Blast Furnace	Crafted

PURSUIITS

Organised by Domain (colour-coded); rows alternate in the Domain tint and *monuments are the purple rows. Build Action Req = the Domain Standing only (the sole build requirement); every Pursuit listed under **Mastery Req** is needed to master, not to build.*

■ Industry ■ Prowess ■ Piety ■ Cunning ■ Edict (Sovereign standing or Monument)

INDUSTRY

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Furnace	—	—	Cast weapons	—
Blacksmith	Rising Industry	Furnace	—	Wrought weapons
Forge	Established Industry	Blacksmith, Furnace	—	Forged weapons
Tannery	—	Animal Husbandry	—	Leather armor
Armory	Rising Industry	Tannery, Blacksmith	—	Chainmail
Gilded Foundry	Established Industry	Armory, Blacksmith	Full Plate	Planishing
Master Workshop	Established Industry	Forge, Blacksmith	—	Serrated
Joinery	Rising Industry	Carpentry	—	Shields
Stable	—	Animal Husbandry, Blacksmith or Carpentry	—	Cavalry weapons (Lance, Cavalry Spear)
Advanced Blast Furnace	Sovereign Industry	Gilded Foundry, Master Workshop, Blacksmith, Stable, Forge	—	Crafted tier

PROWESS

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Conditioning Field	—	—	+1 Endurance	—
Coliseum	Rising Prowess	Conditioning Field	—	Man-at-Arms unlock
Fletcher	—	Carpentry	—	Ranged weapons
Grand Tournament	Established Prowess	Conditioning Field, Coliseum	Improved Parry	Riposte
Tiltyard	Established Prowess	Fletcher, Coliseum	Dual-equip; weapons gain Unwieldy while dual-equipped	Immune Unwieldy
War College	Established Prowess	Levy Hall, Academy	—	Sergeant unlock
Royal Pavilion	Sovereign Prowess	Grand Tournament, Tiltyard	Immune Strain	Drilled, Nimble
Ministry of Military Strategy	Sovereign Prowess	University, War College	Seize the Initiative in Skirmish 1; Immune -1 to-Strike Tactics	Gain +1I, max Initiative +3. Riposte, Deadly, Cleave, and Destroy Shield on natural 5.

PIETY

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Apothecary	—	Herb Garden or Alchemy	—	Heal 4
Infirmary	—	Apothecary, Herb Garden or Alchemy	—	Recover 6; +1 if already gained
Hospitaller	Established Piety	Apothecary, Infirmary	Recover +1	Recover +1
Preceptory of the Knight's Templar	Sovereign Piety + Established Prowess	Monastery, Pilgrimage Site, Hospitaller, Abbey	Immune Panic	Knight Templar unlock

CUNNING

Pursuit	Build Action Req	Mastery Req	Innate Effect	Mastery Effect
Toxicarium	Rising Cunning	Academy	—	Poison
Outrider Intercept Post	Sovereign Cunning	Caravanery, Cipher Chamber	Once each battle (Skirmish 1), see the enemy's Tactic before you choose yours	Every Skirmish, you may force your opponent to reveal their Tactic before you select yours

GLOSSARY

2H — Two-handed: no shield. A Bastard Sword may choose its profile during the declare equipment phase.

AP — Armor Penetration — a weapon's (negative) modifier to the defender's Save roll. Reduce the result of the roll by 1 per AP.

Attacker / Defender — Set by the roll-off. Each Skirmish the Attacker declares equipment first; the Defender then responds.

Battle — One fight between two players (Turn step 1), resolved as a series of Skirmishes until a side is wiped out, Routs, or Falls Back.

Blocked — -1 Initiative in the first Skirmish (negated by Immune Blocked).

Break check — Taken by each Fatigued side's field every Skirmish, just before it gains its Fatigue token. Roll Morale (up to 5 dice); failures are casualties, but a break check never triggers a Panic check. Unbreakable retinues auto-pass it.

Casualty — A retinue removed from the field — from an unsaved Strike or a failed Panic or Break check.

Cleave — Each natural 6 to Strike adds one extra Strike.

Deadly — On a natural 6 to Strike, AP is increased by -5; the Strike can only be Parried or Recovered on a natural 6.

Deflect — Every ranged weapon has it: a ranged Strike is -1 to Parry and never Ripostes.

Destroy Shield — A natural 6 against a shield-bearer destroys their shield for the rest of the Battle.

Drilled — No Endurance loss in the first Skirmish.

Dual-equip — Carry two weapons at once (e.g. melee + ranged). Granted by the Tiltyard, which also gives Unwieldy until its mastery removes it.

Edict — A scoring achievement worth +1 VP: reach a Sovereign Standing, or complete (master) a Monument.

Endurance — A side's stamina. Each side that fights loses 1 per Skirmish; at 0 it becomes Fatigued.

Fall Back — A controlled retreat that ends the Battle with at least one retinue left from the Fall Back tactic — a partial success worth +1 VP.

Fatigue token — Each token is -1 to that army's Strike, Morale, Parry and Recover rolls for the rest of the Battle — all capped at 6+ except Morale, which is uncapped, so enough tokens will Rout the army. They stack.

Fatigued — A side at 0 Endurance. Each Skirmish its field takes a break check, then it gains a Fatigue token (see Fatigue token).

Field — Your retinues in play — front line (up to 10) plus reserve (up to 5). Casualties leave the field at once, lowering its count.

Heal X — At the end of each Skirmish, for every X casualties you took from Strikes, return 1 retinue to your Army.

Immune [keyword] — Cancels that keyword as it applies to you — e.g. Immune Unwieldy, Strain, Blocked, Panic or Destroy Shield.

Improved Parry — Your Parry succeeds on 4+ instead of 5+.

Initiative — Decides who Strikes first each Skirmish (higher first). Runs -2 to +2 (Ministry can raise the maximum to +3). At -2 or lower you Blunder — your Strike value cannot be improved beyond 6+.

Monument — A Domain's capstone Pursuit (the purple rows). Completing one scores its Edict (+1 VP) and grants a powerful effect. Only one of each Monument can be built each game.

Morale — A test used to determine whether retinues Flee as casualties. Break and Panic checks both roll it: a d6 per retinue in the field, up to 5 dice, each $\geq$ its modified Morale value; failures are casualties. Any such check ever modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army.

Natural roll — The number on the die before any modifiers. A natural 6 triggers Cleave, Deadly, Destroy Shield and Riposte — modifiers never change what counts as 'natural'.

Nimble — +1 Initiative in the first Skirmish.

One Shot — A ranged weapon can be equipped in the first Skirmish only. If you have no other weapon, you must use Farm Tools after the first Skirmish. Requires a Tiltyard.

Panic check — Taken at once by a side that suffered 5 or more casualties in a Skirmish, before it Strikes back. Roll a d6 per retinue in the field, up to 5 dice; Immune Panic auto-passes it.

Parry — Roll a d6 to cancel a Strike on a 5+ (a natural 6 is a Riposte). -1 versus Unstoppable, versus ranged, and per Fatigue token (to a maximum of 6+). A Deadly Strike can only be Parried on a natural 6.

Planishing — Your to Save cannot be reduced beyond 6+

Poison — The defender's Save fails on a natural 6 (Toxicarium mastery).

Recover X — After a failed Parry and Save, roll a d6: a result of X+ saves the retinue (worsened by Fatigue and Serrated, to a maximum of 6+). Against a Deadly Strike, only a natural 6 Recovers.

Riposte — A Parry of a natural 6 cancels the Strike and Strikes back once; it does not bypass a Deadly Strike's natural-6 restriction.

Rout — The army breaks and leaves the Battle (you lose it). A Panic or break check ever modified to 7 or more Routs the whole army automatically.

Save — The defender's roll to avoid a casualty: roll a d6, add the weapon's AP (a negative) and the shield's Save bonus (a positive); the hit is saved on a result $\geq$ the armor value (Cloth 6+ ... Gothic Plate 2+).

Seize the Initiative — Won by the roll-off at the start of the Battle — the winner of their last Battle adds +1 to the roll. You become the Attacker and gain +1 Initiative in the first Skirmish. Some Tactics and the Ministry monument also grant it.

Serrated — Your Strikes worsen the enemy's Recover roll by 1 — enough to deny Recover entirely. (Master Workshop mastery.)

Shield (-1 to Strike) — Attackers Striking a shield-bearer take -1 to the Strike roll.

Skirmish — One round of a Battle, run through the numbered Battle steps; a Battle repeats Skirmishes until it ends.

Steady — Your Initiative cannot be reduced by Tactics.

Strained — -1 Initiative every Skirmish (negated by Immune Strain).

Strike — A landed hit. Roll a d6, apply modifiers to the roll, and Strike on a result $\geq$ the to-Strike number. The target may then Parry, Save, and Recover.

Tactic — A choice both players make secretly and reveal together each Skirmish; it can shift Initiative and Strike rolls.

to-Strike — The d6 result a retinue needs to roll to successfully Strike. Bonuses add to the roll; penalties and Fatigue tokens subtract.

Unbreakable — Automatically passes all Break checks.

Unstoppable — Ignore the target shield's -1 to Strike, and the target's Parry is -1 against you.

Unwieldy — Your Initiative cannot be improved by Tactics.